

JOSEPH T. HIGDON JR.

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EDUCATION

Cape Fear Community College

August 2026 - January 2027

- Fundamentals of GIS / ESRI GIS Fundamentals Foundation Certification

University of North Carolina - Wilmington

January 2022 - December 2024

- Bachelor of Arts in Environmental Science - GPA 3.379

Central Piedmont Community College

August 2019 - December 2021

- Associate in Arts - GPA 3.19

RESEARCH AND COURSE EXPERIENCE

Directed Individual Study (Dr. Christopher Dumas)

August 2024 - December 2024

- Utilize data to submit a research report and GIS analysis of the co-occurrence of Marine Fisheries and offshore wind farms using target species and vessel gear types along the Atlantic Coast of the United States.
- Use GIS data and tools to measure the distance beyond offshore wind farms that must be reached for commercial fishing areas.

Introduction to Remote Sensing (GGY 322)

January 2024 - May 2024

- Collect, process, and analyze satellite imagery data using the ESRI software.

Communicating Environmental Issues (EVS 321)

January 2024 - May 2024

- Research, organize, and perform a Ted Talk discussing the harmful impacts of PFAs and other water contaminants on Life and the Environment.

Human Dimensions in Natural Resource Management (EVS 360)

January 2024 - April 2024

- Work in a group environment to conduct research, organize results, and create a Visitor Use Management (VUM) Framework outlining the Human and Wildlife interaction in Big Bend National Park.

Introduction to GIS (GGY 321)

August 2023 - December 2023

- Collect and analyze data while properly showcasing the results in ArcGIS Pro.

Natural Resource Policy (EVS 364)

January 2023 - May 2023

- Create and present a presentation on the Marine Mammal Protection Act, including how it was created, what it does, and who it was created by.

Writing in Science (ENG 393)

May 2023 - June 2023

- Researched and submitted a final report and infographic outlining the environmental effects of firefighting foam and PFAs.

Ecology (BIO 366)

January 2022 - May 2022

- Research conducted and final research report submitted with the topic of how burn regimes can affect the A-Layer of soils.

EMPLOYMENT

Pike Engineering

June 2025 - Current

Power Engineering Technologist

- Support electrical distribution design and engineering projects.
- Apply utility standards, regulations, and engineering guidelines to project work.
- Collaborate with engineering teams, field personnel, construction crews, and clients.

Wrightsville Beach Fire Department

September 2022 - Current

Volunteer/Paid-on-call Firefighter

- Earn CPR Certification (2022, renewed 2025).
- Provide fire suppression and basic first aid, while also promoting fire prevention techniques.
- Experience and training with quick problem-solving skills in stressful or intense situations.
- Volunteer Firefighter of the Year Award - 2024.